



## Diversity and Culture

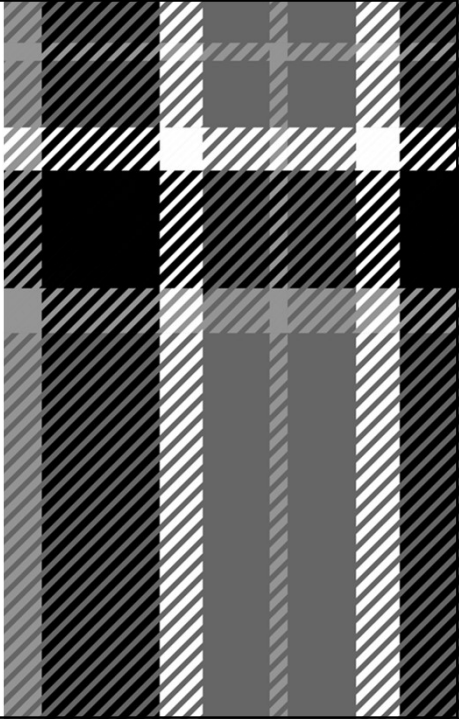
### Why the study of diversity and culture is important?

**Broadened Perspectives:** Exposure to diverse cultures fosters open-mindedness and a broader worldview, helping students understand and appreciate different perspectives.

**Critical Thinking:** Engaging with various cultural contexts encourages critical thinking about social issues, power dynamics, and the impact of cultural norms on behavior.

**Improved Communication:** Understanding cultural differences enhances communication skills, which are essential in both personal and professional contexts, especially in a globalized world.

**Social Responsibility:** Awareness of diversity promotes social responsibility and empathy, preparing students to engage thoughtfully with diverse communities and advocate for social justice.



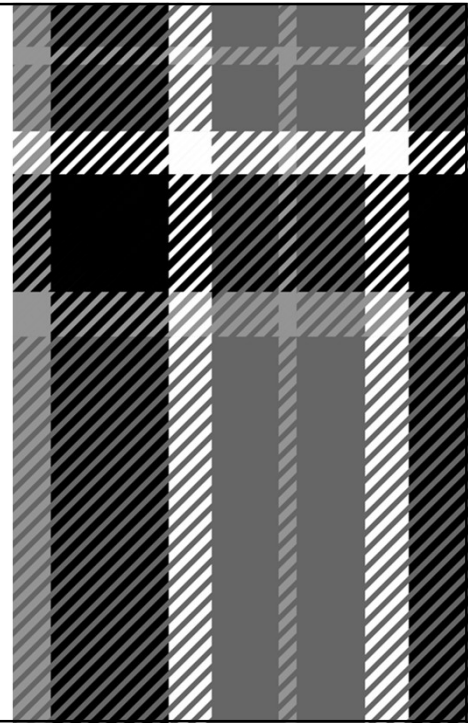
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**Workplace Preparedness:** Many careers require collaboration with people from different backgrounds. Familiarity with cultural diversity equips students to work effectively in diverse teams.

**Innovation and Creativity:** Exposure to varied cultural ideas can inspire creativity and innovation, as diverse viewpoints often lead to new solutions and approaches.

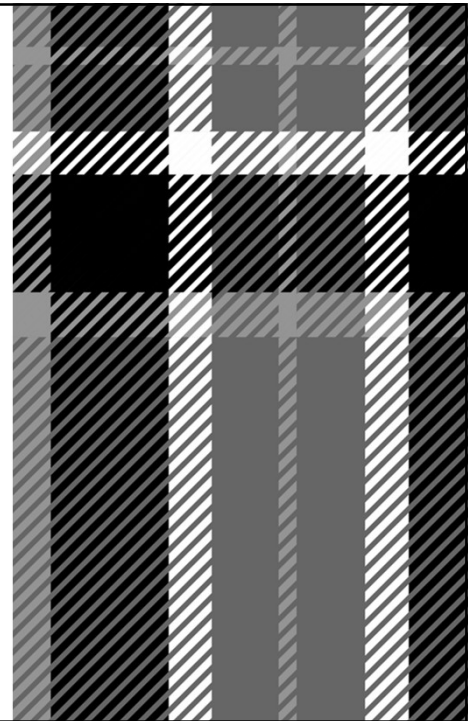
**Personal Growth:** Engaging with different cultures fosters personal development, self-awareness, and a deeper understanding of one's own cultural identity.

Overall, the study of culture and diversity enriches the educational experience and prepares students to navigate an increasingly interconnected world.



## Diversity

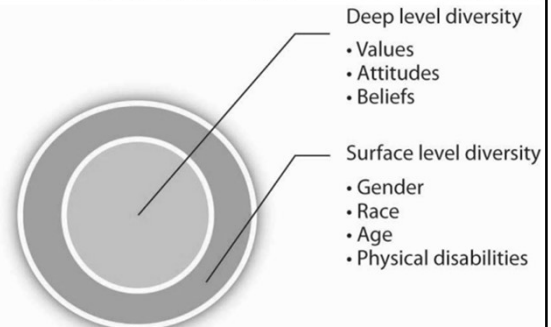
- Diversity refers to the ways in which people are **similar or different from each other**. It may be defined by any characteristic that varies within a particular work unit such as gender, race, age, education, tenure, or functional background.
- What are the **benefits and challenges** of diversity in the organizations?



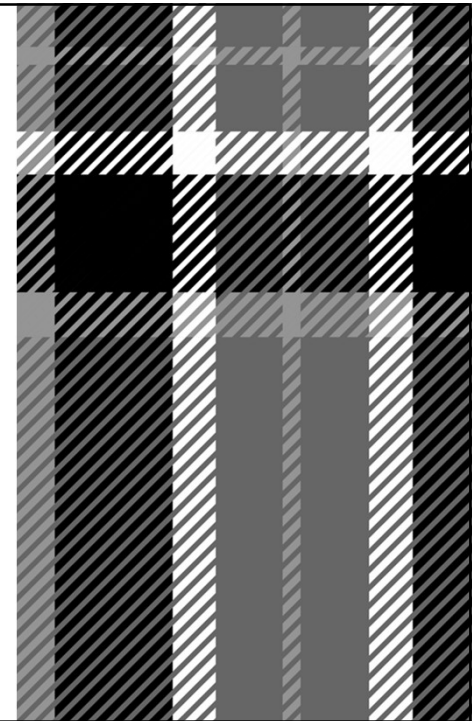
## Levels of Diversity

**Surface-level diversity:** Differences in easily perceived characteristics, such as gender, race, ethnicity, or age, that do not necessarily reflect the ways people think or feel but that may activate certain stereotypes.

**Deep-level diversity:** Differences in values, personality, and work preferences that become progressively more important for determining similarity as people get to know one another better.



**Biographical characteristics:** Personal characteristics—such as age, gender, race, and ethnicity—that are objective and easily obtained from personnel records. These characteristics are representative of **surface-level diversity**.



## RACE VS. ETHNICITY

What's the Difference?

| Race                                                                                                 | Ethnicity                                                                                        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Refers to a person's physical characteristics such as skin color, hair texture, and facial features. | Refers to a person's cultural background, including language, religion, customs, and traditions. |
| Often used to categorize people based on physical appearance.                                        | Often used to describe a person's cultural identity.                                             |
| Can be a socially constructed concept with no biological basis.                                      | Can be a complex and multifaceted identity that includes many different cultural factors.        |
| Examples: Black, White, Asian, Native American.                                                      | Examples: Hispanic, African, Jewish, Irish.                                                      |



## Age in the workplace

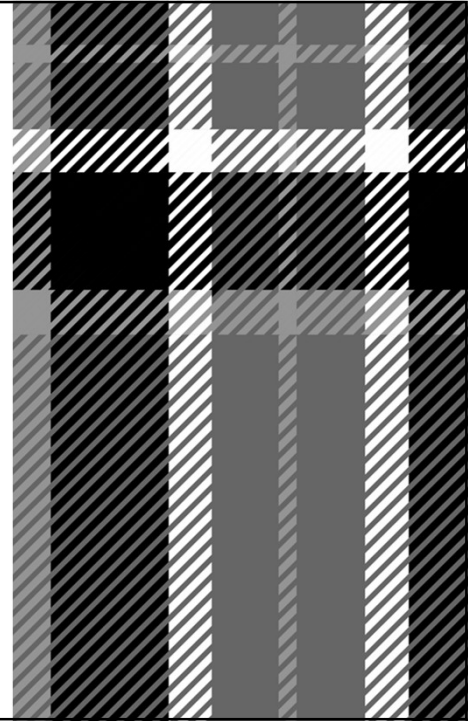
**Age:** Age in the workforce is likely to be an issue of increasing importance during the next decade for many reasons. For one, the **workforce is aging worldwide in most developed countries.**

Stereotypes of older workers as being **behind the times, grumpy, and inflexible** are changing. Managers often see a number of positive qualities that older workers bring to their jobs, such as **experience, judgment, a strong work ethic, and a commitment** to quality.

## Generational Differences

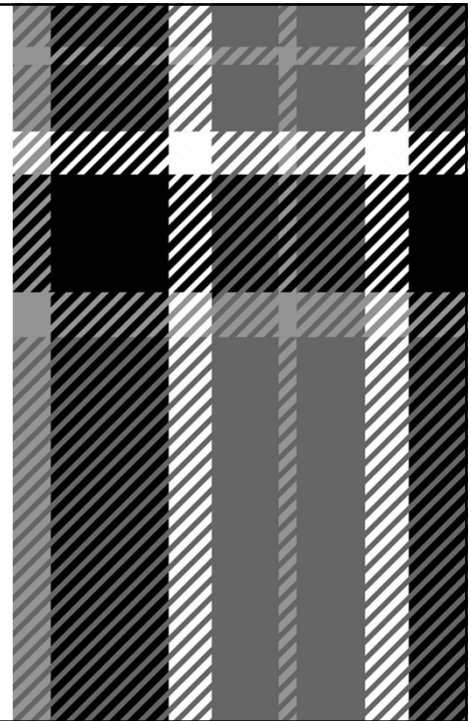
### Baby Boomers

Baby Boomers are roughly between the ages of **55 and 75**. This generation of workers tends to **seek advancement** and be **goal-oriented** in their careers. They value **in-person interaction** and some **structure, or hierarchy**, in the workplace.



## Generation X

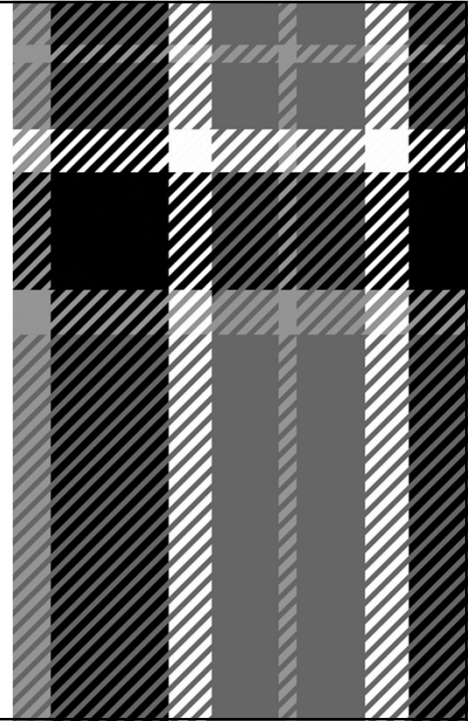
Members of Generation X are currently between the ages of **40 and 60**, roughly speaking. These employees are approaching the **midpoint** of their careers and potential peak-earning years. As the first generation to experience **both parents working outside** the home, these employees tend to be **hard-working, adaptable, and digitally savvy**.



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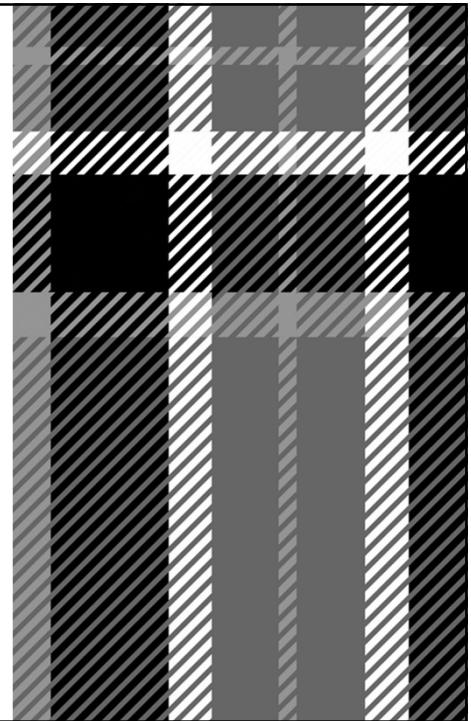
### Generation Y (Millennials)

Millennials are workers currently between the ages of 20 and 40. These employees are characterized as **tech-savvy, achievement-oriented**, and focused on using their professional careers to better the world. These workers seek to make their work mean something more than just a paycheck.



## Generation Z

Generation Z is the youngest group in the workforce, currently between the ages of 18 and 25 (though, note that many members of Gen Z aren't of the legal age to enter the labor market just yet). So far, this generation seems most **motivated by salary**. They are the first **true digital natives**, having never grown up without the internet. Gen Z is also one of the most diverse generations to enter the workforce in history.



## 5 benefits of age diversity in the workplace

1. Increased productivity
2. Improve skill diversity
3. Build an inclusive business
4. Create mentorship opportunities
5. Improve employee retention

Source: <https://vervoe.com/age-diversity/>

## Prejudice and stereotypes

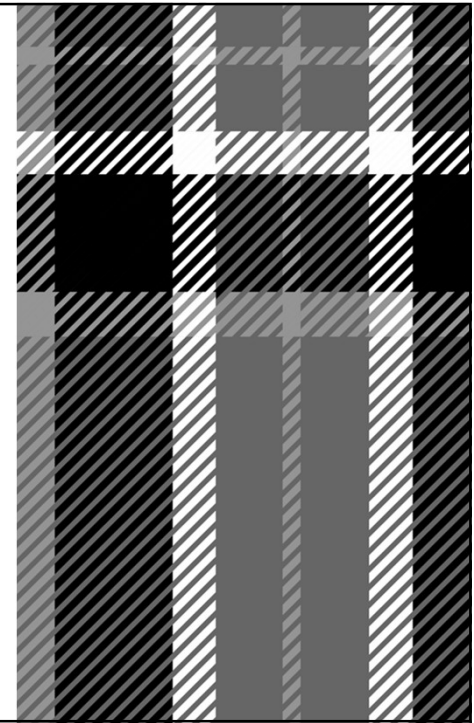
**Prejudice** is a preconceived, biased feeling or belief about a particular group of people or things.

**Stereotypes** are characteristics that society instinctively attributes to groups of people to classify them according to age, weight, occupation, skin color, gender, etc.

<https://open.maricopa.edu/culturepsychology/chapter/stereotypes-prejudice-and-discrimination/>

# Discrimination

**Discrimination:** Actions or behaviors that create, maintain, or reinforce some groups' advantages over other groups and their members.



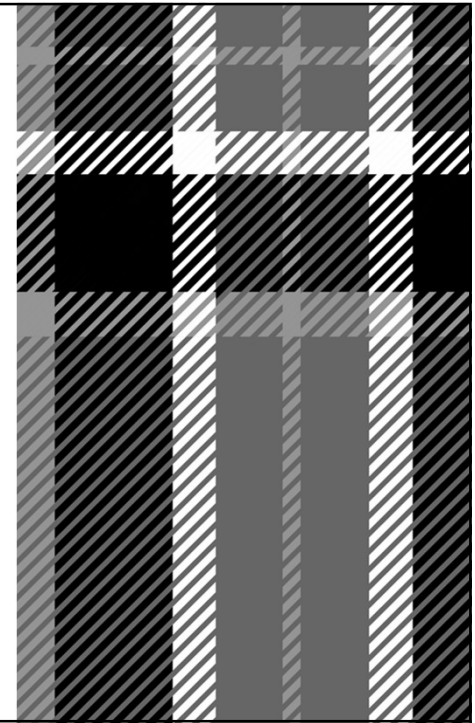
| Exhibit 2-1 Forms of Discrimination  |                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Type of Discrimination               | Definition                                                                                                                            | Examples from Organizations                                                                                                                                             |
| Discriminatory policies or practices | Actions taken by representatives of the organization that deny equal opportunity to perform or unequal rewards for performance.       | Older workers may be targeted for layoffs because they are highly paid and have lucrative benefits.                                                                     |
| Sexual harassment                    | Unwanted sexual advances and other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature that create a hostile or offensive work environment. | Salespeople at one company went on company-paid visits to strip clubs, brought strippers into the office to celebrate promotions, and fostered pervasive sexual rumors. |
| Intimidation                         | Overt threats or bullying directed at members of specific groups of employees.                                                        | Black employees at some companies have found nooses hanging over their work stations.                                                                                   |
| Mockery and insults                  | Jokes or negative stereotypes; sometimes the result of jokes taken too far.                                                           | Arab employees have been asked at work whether they were carrying bombs or were members of terrorist organizations.                                                     |
| Exclusion                            | Exclusion of certain people from job opportunities, social events, discussions, or informal mentoring; can occur unintentionally.     | Many women in finance claim they are assigned to marginal job roles or are given light workloads that do not lead to promotion.                                         |
| Incivility                           | Disrespectful treatment, including behaving in an aggressive manner, interrupting the person, or ignoring their opinions.             | Women attorneys note that they are frequently cut off when speaking and that others do not adequately acknowledge their comments.                                       |

## Culture

The word "culture" derives from a French term, which in turn derives from the Latin "colere," which means to tend to the earth and grow, or cultivation and nurture" (Cristina De Rossi)

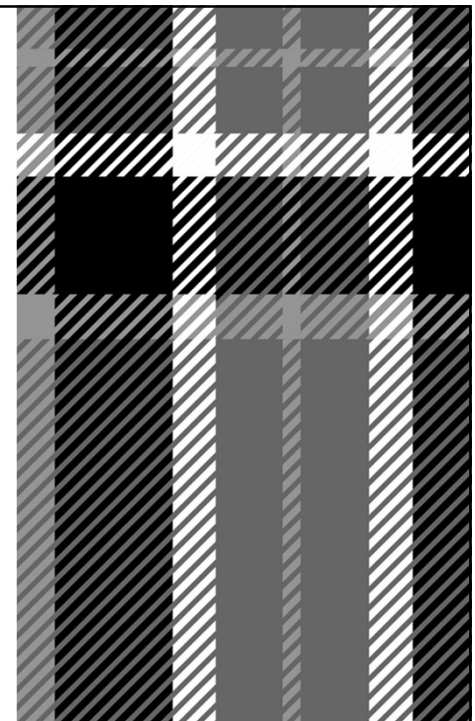
In this sense culture is the man-made environment and the people living in a society actually grow their way of life over time.

Western culture, European culture, Bengali culture etc.



## Defining Culture

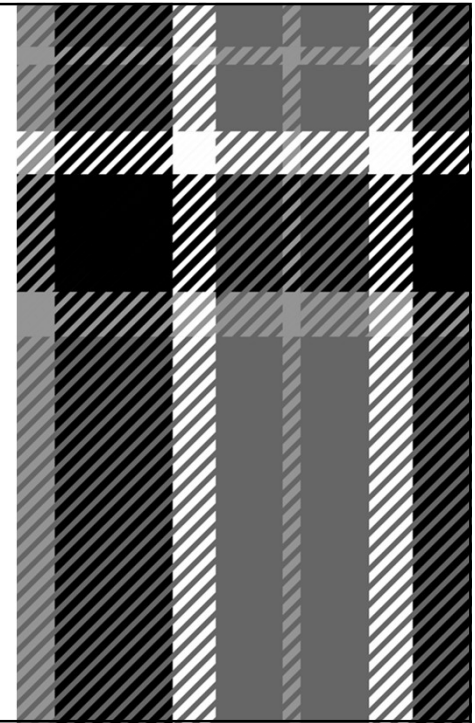
- Culture ... is that complex whole which includes knowledge, belief, arts, morals, laws, customs, and any other capabilities and habits acquired by man as a member of society. (Edward B. Taylor ,1871:1)
- Culture is the ways of thinking, the ways of acting, and the material objects that together form a people's way of life (Macionis, 2012: 54)



## Characteristics of Culture

**Culture is learnt;** Culture is not inherited biologically, but **learnt** socially by man. It is not an inborn tendency. There is no cultural instinct as such culture is often "Learned ways of behavior".

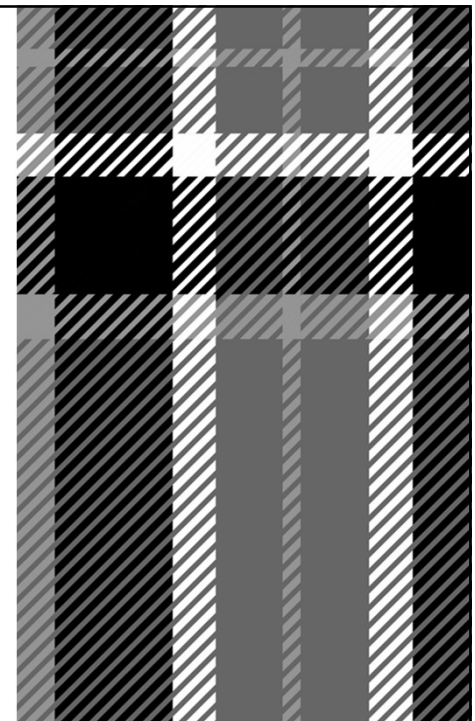
**Culture is social;** Culture does not exist in isolation. Neither is it an individual phenomenon. **It is a product of society.** It originates and develops through social interactions. It is shared by the members of society.



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**Culture is shared;** Culture in the sociological sense, is something shared. It is not something that an individual alone can possess. For example, customs, traditions, beliefs, ideas, values, morals etc. are all shared by people of a group or society.

**Culture is transmissive;** Culture is capable of being transmitted from one generation to the other. Parents pass on culture traits to their children, and they in turn to their children, and so on. Culture is transmitted **not through genes** but by means of language. Language is the main vehicle of culture.



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**Culture is dynamic and adaptive;** Though culture is relatively stable it is not altogether static. It is subjected to **slow** but **constant changes**. Culture is responsive to the changing conditions of the physical world as it assists us to survive and adapt to the changes.

**Culture varies from society to society;** Every society has a culture of its own. It **differs from society to society**. Culture of every society is unique to itself. Cultures are not uniform.

## Components of Culture

- Values
- Norms
- Symbols
- Language

## Values and beliefs

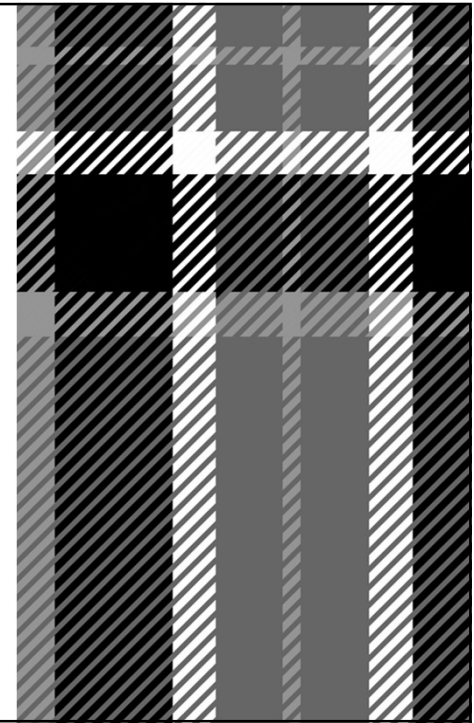
**Values** – Collective concept of what is good, bad, desirable, proper, and improper and that serve as broad guidelines for social living.

Values indicate what people find important and morally right (or wrong)

- Respect for parents, elders
- Cleanliness
- Generosity

Values are broad principles that support beliefs.

**Beliefs** are specific thoughts or ideas that people hold to be true.



## Norms

**Norms;** rules developed by a group of people that specify how people must, should, may, should not and must not behave in various situations.

These are rules and expectations by which a society guides the behavior of its members.

### NORMS VERSUS VALUES

| NORMS                                                                                                                     | VALUES                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Norms are accepted standards of behaviour                                                                                 | Values are principles that help you to decide what is right and wrong |
| Specific guidelines                                                                                                       | General guidelines                                                    |
| Behaviours that are accepted by the society                                                                               | Principals believed by an individual                                  |
| May vary from society to society                                                                                          | May vary from individual to individual                                |
| Ex: covering your mouth when coughing, shaking hands when you meet someone, saying sorry when you bump into someone, etc. | Ex: honesty, integrity, courage, kindness, fairness, and generosity   |

Visit [www.PEDIAA.com](http://www.PEDIAA.com)

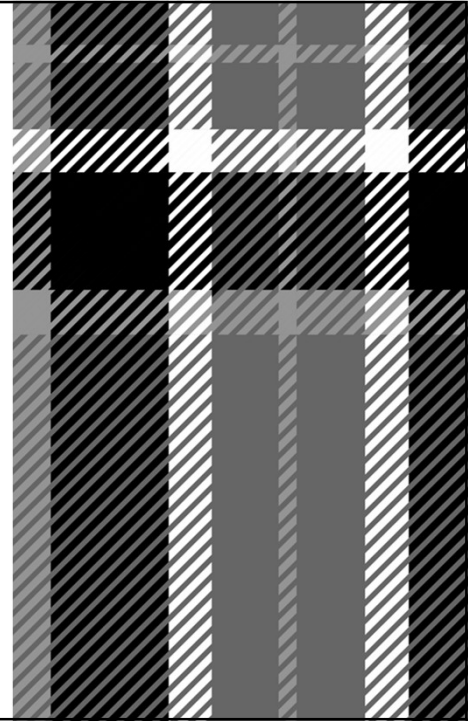
## Folkways, Mores, and Laws

**Folkways** are informal norms or everyday customs that may be violated **without serious consequences** within a particular culture.

Norms of routine or casual interaction (ex. Shaking hands, eating styles, saying excuse me)

**Mores** –(pronounced MOR-ays). Mores norms that are widely observed and have great moral significance. Often breaking norms lead to being outcast or imprisonment (ex. Incest, rape, murder) are strict norms that control moral and ethical behavior.

**Laws-** are formal, standardized norms that have been enacted by legislatures and are enforced by formal sanctions.

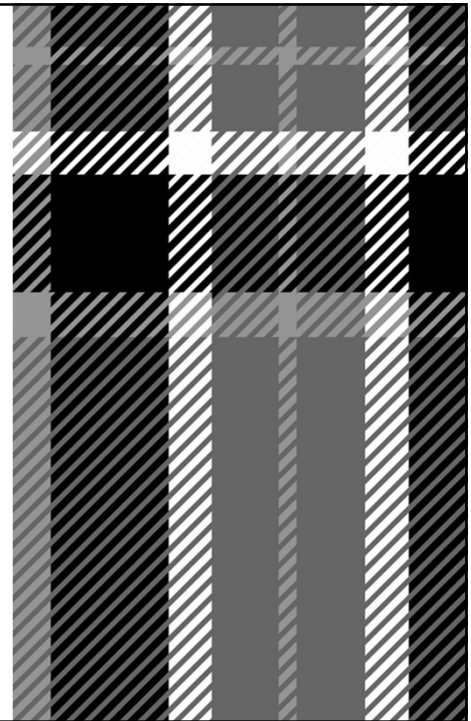


## Taboos

**Taboos** are mores specifying what actions are prohibited in a culture.

Taboos are mores so strong that their violation is considered to be extremely offensive and even unmentionable.

Taboo meaning a culture absolutely forbids them. Eating human flesh – cannibalism, Incest



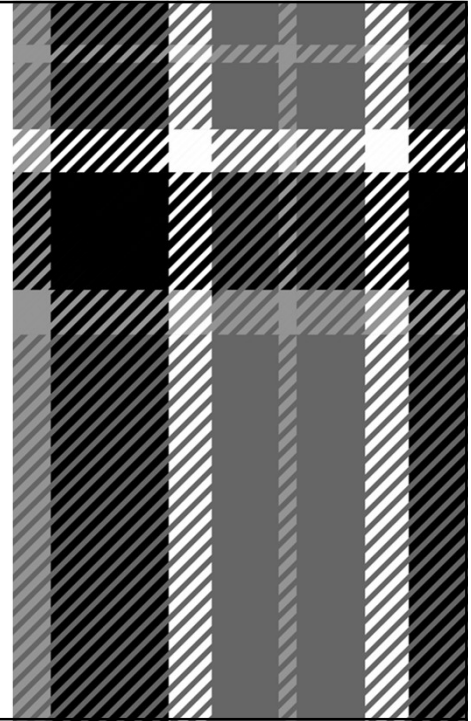
## Symbols

**Symbols:** A symbol is an object, word, or action that stands for something else.

Symbol is anything that carries a particular meaning recognized by people who share a culture (a flag, a word, a flashing red light, a raised fist, an animal etc).

Symbols help us communicate ideas. A siren is a symbol that denotes an emergency situation and sends the message to clear the way immediately

**Non-verbal gestures** can be very "symbolic" and diverse.

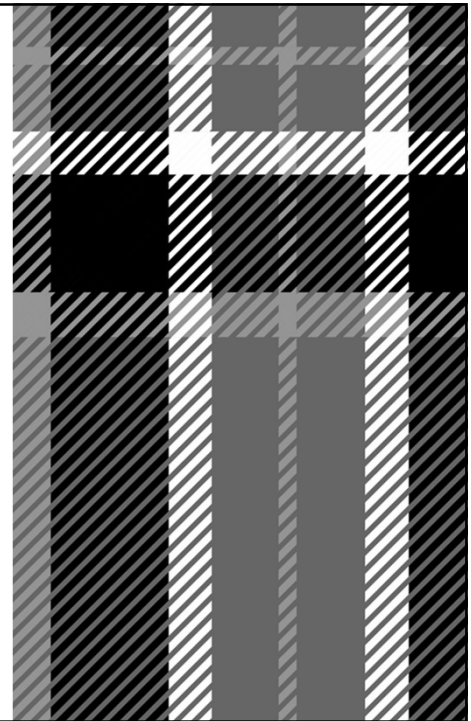


## Language

**Language:** Culture is the social heritage of the humans that is transmitted to the future generation mainly through language.

Language is a system of words and symbols used to communicate with other people. Language is a set of symbols that expresses ideas and enables people to think and communicate with one another.

Verbal (spoken) language and nonverbal (written or gestured) language help us describe reality.

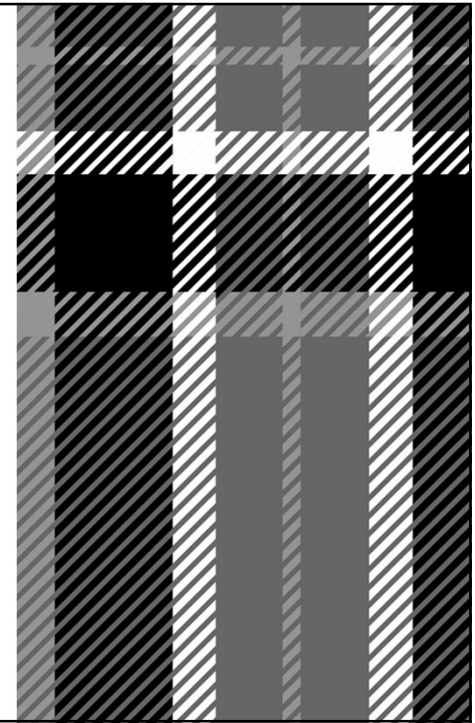


## Ethnocentrism & Cultural Shock

**Ethnocentrism;** the tendency to judge other cultures according to the norms and values of our own culture. Ethnocentrism is based on the assumption that one's own way of life is **superior** to all others.

**Culture shock** is the term we use to describe the feelings of confusion and uncertainty that are experienced when you come into contact with a culture that is vastly different from your own.

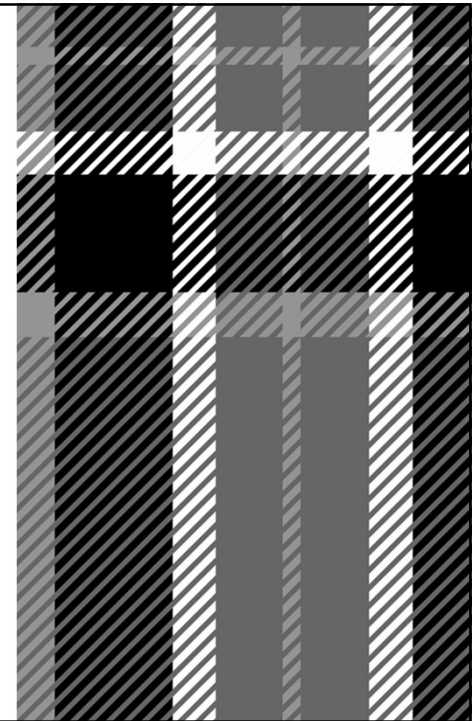
Culture shock can be commonly seen in foreign students, immigrants and refugees. Suddenly, you find yourself unable to understand.



## Hofstede's Cultural Dimensions

Hofstede's Framework: One of the most widely referenced approaches for analyzing variations among cultures was introduced in the late 1970s by Geert Hofstede.

Hofstede surveyed more than **116,000 IBM employees** in **forty countries** about their **work-related values** and found that managers and employees varied on five value dimensions of national culture:



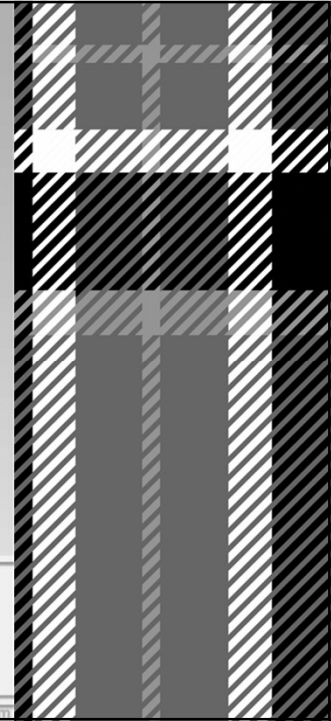


| Individualist Cultures                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Collectivist Cultures                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- The <b>individual</b> is the most important</li> <li>- Focus on individual goals and achievement</li> <li>- Promotes <u>self expression</u>, <u>individual thinking</u>, <u>personal choice</u></li> <li>- Personal privacy and space are important</li> <li>- Business is competitive (focus on leadership)</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- The <b>group</b> is most important</li> <li>- Focus on well-being and goals of the group</li> <li>- Promotes <u>respect for others</u> and <u>teamwork</u></li> <li>- Relationship, collaboration, and sharing are important</li> <li>- Business is collaborative (focus on membership)</li> </ul> |

Source: Hannah Bierbaum

## High vs. Low power distance

| Features of high power distance cultures                                                                           | Features of low power distance cultures                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Members accept power distance as part of social order, it determines what is right and wrong.                      | Power is exerted only where it is necessary.                       |
| More powerful members of society perceive their subordinates as unequal.                                           | People are equal, they consider social inequalities obsolete.      |
| Subordinates fear the more powerful members.                                                                       | Cooperation should be based on the principle of solidarity.        |
| There is not much trust among co-workers                                                                           | Subordinates are considered as older, more experienced colleagues. |
| Majority of people are dependent on others.                                                                        | Co-workers are prone to trust one another.                         |
| Subordinates are blamed for mistakes.                                                                              | The system is blamed for mistakes.                                 |
| There is a strong conflict between the strong and the weak members                                                 | Everyone should have equal rights                                  |
| Social inequalities are accepted; every person has a high or low place in the social order and is protected by law | Strong and weak members coexist in harmony                         |



### *Uncertainty Avoiding societies*

- The uncertainty inherent in life is a threat that must be fought
- High stress and anxiety
- Aggression and emotions may sometimes be vented
- What is different, is dangerous
- Need for rules, even if not practical and/or not practised
- Formalization
- Adoption of innovations slow
- Staying in the same job
- Xenophobia

### *Uncertainty Accepting societies*

- Uncertainty is normal, life is accepted as it comes
- Low stress and anxiety
- Aggression and emotions should be controlled
- What is different, is curious
- Fewer rules, which may be broken if necessary
- Deregulation
- Adoption of innovations fast
- Changing jobs easily
- Tolerance

## D.4 Masculinity versus Femininity

| Masculinity                                                       | Femininity                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dominant values in society are material success and progress      | Dominant values in society are caring for others and preservation                  |
| Money and things are important                                    | People and warm relationships are important                                        |
| Men are supposed to be assertive, ambitious, and tough            | Everybody is supposed to be modest                                                 |
| Women are supposed to be tender and to take care of relationships | Both men and women are allowed to be tender and to be concerned with relationships |
| Sympathy for the strong                                           | Sympathy for the weak                                                              |
|                                                                   |                                                                                    |

## Traits

### Short-Term Orientation

- People in short-term oriented culture are more concerned with truth than virtue.
- They care about present virtue and do not necessarily follow traditions.
- They are more willing to spend for the present.
- Good partnerships are not necessarily equivalent to long-term relationships.

### Long-Term Orientation

- The issue of virtue is particularly important in Asia.
- People in long-term oriented culture tend to concern about future virtue and traditions.
- They are willing to save for the future.
- They value long-term partnership.

## Like the Other Dimensions, Indulgence Has Two Orientations

### Cultures with an orientation towards **INDULGENCE**:

- Have fewer restrictions on behavior
- Value free expression of opinions
- Are more likely to display optimism
- Tend to be more active in sports; value leisure
- Have a higher crime rate

### Cultures with an orientation towards **RESTRAINT**:

- Have more restrictions on behavior
- Feel that free expression of opinions is unimportant
- Are more likely to display pessimism
- Have less participation in sports; value the work ethic
- Have a lower crime rate

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## Suggestions for Managing Cultural Diversity

- Help Employees Build Cultural Intelligence
- Avoid Ethnocentrism
- Listen to Locals
- Recognize That Culture Changes
- Do Not Always Assume That Culture Is the Problem